leading to stringency in the market was increasing. (In G.D. Birla, *Indian Currency in Retrospect*, Allahabad, pp. 13–14).

The Hilton Young Commission

1 Edward Hilton Young was a former Treasury minister who was the editor of the *Financial News*. He supported sterling's return to gold at the prewar parity and was committed to the new London orthodoxy of a gold exchange standard.

2 *History* (Vol.1), p. 53.

3 The main British representative and its most influential member, Strakosch, had started his career as a foreign exchange dealer in London and later was the Managing Director of the Union Corporation which held extensive interests in South African gold mining. An insider of the London business establishment he played a major role in preventing South Africa's return to the gold standard in 1920. He was opposed to a gold standard for India and was the Chairman of *The Economist* from 1929 to 1943. He advanced an interest free loan to Sir Winston Churchill when the demagogue long having lived beyond his means was facing financial problems. On Strakosch's death, his will revealed that the loan had been converted into a gift.

4 G.H. Baxter of the India Office and A. Ayangar of the Indian Finance Department were the Secretaries. A.V.V. Aiyar fell ill and was replaced by A. Ayangar.

5 Frank Moraes, *Op. Cit.*, p. 76–77.

6 *Ibid.*, p. 77.

7 G. Balachandran, *John Bullion's Empire: Britain's Gold Problem and India between the Wars*, Curzon Press, Surrey, 1996, pp. 141–143.

8 *Aditya Mukherjee*, *Imperialism, Nationalism and the Making of the Indian Capitalist Class, 1902–1947*, Sage Publications Pvt. Ltd, New Delhi, 2002, p. 82

9 *Ibid.*, p. 82.

10 Frank Moraes, *Op. Cit.*, p. 79.

11 Report of the Royal Commission on Indian Currency and Finance, Vol.